

## Techcom SSD-8in1 1.1Card Reader

Read one, read all

The SSD-8in1 card reader can read flash memory card and plugs into a USB port. It can read Compact Flash (CF), MultiMedia Card (MMC), SmartMedia (SM), MemoryStick, SecureDigital (SD), Microdrive cards and xD-Picturecard formats.

Once the reader is plugged to the system, Explorer shows a total of 5



drives. The advantage of this is that you can plug in different cards, and read or write to all of them simultaneously. The disadvantage is the reduced bandwidth shared across four slots.

We tested it with the Princeton 32 MB Compact Flash card. In SiSoft Sandra 2004 Pro, it logged a score of 936 KBps. The sequential read maxed out at 949 KBps

**Price:** Rs 1,090  
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and sequential write topped at 943 KBps. For a card reader, sequential data transfer is more important over random, as it is used mainly to transfer large images, music files or short video clips. The random read and write score was 948 KBps and 801 KBps respectively, which is quite good.

The card shows 30.6 MB of space, and we tested it by transferring a 30.4 MB single file and the same amount of assorted data. It took 35.26 and 41.12 seconds respectively.

This card reader costs just Rs 1,090, which not only makes it affordable, but a must have for all those with cards plugged into your digital cameras, PDAs, etc. Since it can both read and write to the cards, you could also use it as a USB memory stick.

### SPECIFICATIONS

USB 1.1 interface, USB cord, four slots, supports MMC, SD, SM, MemoryStick, Microdrive, xD-Picturecard

|                                  |           |    |
|----------------------------------|-----------|----|
| Techcom SSD-8in1 1.1 Card Reader |           | B+ |
| Performance                      | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Features                         | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Ease of Use                      | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Value for money                  | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |

## Simmtronics USB PnP 128 MB Flash Drive

### The Plug and Play Drive

The Simmtronics USB Flash drive is extremely light, and is among the thinnest we've tested so far; measuring just 10.3 mm, or less than half an inch. Despite its size, the build quality is good.

The installation was simple and was immediately detected in both Windows XP and Windows 98, but needed

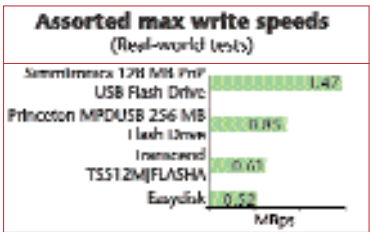
the driver CD for proper installation in 98. For data protection, the drive only features a physical write-protection switch, and lacks a software password-locking tool. In fact, besides the driver CD, the package only includes a carry strap and a short extension cable.

We ran Drive Benchmark from the SiSoft Sandra 2004, to gauge the theoretical transfer speeds. The sequential write

speed of 923 KBps reported was the highest we have ever logged for a USB Flash drive. The CPU utilisation, as reported in HDTach, was very low. In the real world tests too, the drive turned in an excellent performance in the assorted write test with a high data transfer speed of 1.47 MBps.

The Simmtronics USB PnP Flash drive is a good deal for just Rs 3,000, you get amazing performance.

**Price:** Rs 3,000  
**Contact:** Silicon Impex Pvt. Ltd.  
**Phone:** 011-54618247/48/49  
**Fax:** 011-31061852  
**E-mail:** a\_silicon@rediffmail.com



### SPECIFICATIONS

USB 1.1, 128 MB capacity, physical dimensions 73.6 x 24 x 10.3 mm, carry strap, extension cable

|                                        |           |    |
|----------------------------------------|-----------|----|
| Simmtronics USB PnP 128 MB Flash Drive |           | B+ |
| Performance                            | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Features                               | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Build quality                          | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Value for money                        | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |

## Samsung SP1614C 160 GB SATA hard drive

### Bigger is better!

The Samsung SP1614C uses the SATA interface, which is becoming the interface of choice on the latest motherboards. It also has an 8 MB buffer to speed up the data throughput.

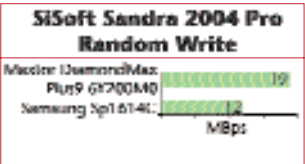
Performance-wise, its results were on par with other SATA models tested earlier. The SiSoft Sandra 2004 Pro test returned a drive index of 41,724 with sequential read touching 62 MBps and access time as low as 7ms.

The drive logged a decent random read/write score of 12 MBps. It logged a relatively high CPU utilisation of 4.4 per cent in the HDTach 2.60 tests. The drive we received wasn't bundled with any kind of manual or documentation, nor was any interface or power cable supplied.

The SP1614C is best suited for gaming PCs and work-



stations that need fast and continuous data access. With a price tag of Rs 7,000, it also goes well with a home system that has a horde of mp3 songs, movies and images.



### SPECIFICATIONS

150 MBps, SATA interface, 8 MB buffer, 7,200 rpm fluid dynamic bearing motor, Weight: 653 gm

**Price:** Rs 7,000  
**Contact:** Samsung Electronics india information & telecommunication ltd  
**Phone:** 011-51511234  
**Fax:** 011-51608820  
**hddsupport@samsungindia.com**  
**Web site:** www.samsungindia.com

|                                        |           |    |
|----------------------------------------|-----------|----|
| Samsung SP1614C 160 GB SATA hard drive |           | A- |
| Performance                            | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Features                               | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Build quality                          | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |
| Value for money                        | ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ |    |

